

Fire Prevention and Emergency Response Procedures

Reference: 29 CFR 1910.157 - OSHA Fire Safety

Fire Prevention Plan

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.39 requires employers to have a written fire prevention plan including: list of major fire hazards, proper storage/handling of hazardous materials, ignition source control procedures, and housekeeping practices. Plan must be reviewed with each employee.

Fire Extinguisher Types

Class A: Ordinary combustibles (wood, paper, cloth) - water, foam, dry chemical. Class B: Flammable liquids/gases - CO₂, dry chemical, foam. Class C: Electrical equipment - CO₂, dry chemical (non-conductive). Class D: Combustible metals - dry powder only. Class K: Kitchen cooking oils - wet chemical agents.

PASS Technique

P - Pull the safety pin to break the tamper seal. A - Aim the nozzle at the base of the fire, not the flames. S - Squeeze the handle to discharge the extinguishing agent. S - Sweep from side to side at the base until fire is out. Extinguishers must be inspected monthly and serviced annually.

Fire Emergency Evacuation

Upon fire alarm activation: immediately stop work, close doors and windows, activate nearest pull station if not already alarmed, use nearest safe exit (not elevators), proceed to designated assembly point, report to floor warden, do not re-enter building until authorized by fire department.

Fire Watch Requirements

A fire watch must be posted during and after hot work operations (welding, cutting, grinding) for a minimum of 30 minutes. Fire watch personnel must have a fire extinguisher, knowledge of fire alarm activation, and authority to stop hot work. Document fire watch activities in the hot work permit.

Emergency Action Plan

EAP must include: emergency escape procedures and route assignments, procedures for critical operations before evacuation, headcount procedures, rescue/medical duties, means of reporting emergencies, and contact list. Must be reviewed annually and updated when facility layout changes.

